MINDGLASS PROCEDURE

Memory, Grief, and the Repetition of Avoidance

Cover image. A film still from the laboratory reveal in Mindglass Procedure (2025).

An in-depth critical analysis

A close reading of narrative structure, symbolism, cinematography, production design, memory modification, grief avoidance, and informed consent.

Film	Mindglass Procedure (2025), short film, approximately 5 minutes
Directors / writers	Kaiya Crowley and Dominic Venticinque
Production	Made in association with Arbitrary Rhapsody
Competition	SkillsUSA NLSC Digital Cinema, 2025; national silver medal

Contents

Abstract and scope

1. The Film as a Primary Text

2. The Opening Montage: Fragmented Memory and Time

3. The Photograph: Evidence Outside Conscious Recall

4. The Neighborhood: Artificial Normality and Surveillance

5. Louis, Greta, and the Performance of Care

6. Noah's Name and the Return of Context

7. Water, the Hourglass, and Recurring Visual Motifs

8. The Laboratory, the Recording, and Informed Consent

9. Grief Avoidance and Real-World Psychological Research

10. Memory Modification, Identity, and Autonomy

11. The Nine-Procedure Loop and the Unresolved Ending

12. Cinematography, Editing, Production Design, and Sound

13. The Title and Surname as Compact Thematic Devices

14. Limitations and Alternative Readings

Conclusion

15. Production Context and Recognition

References and further viewing

Abstract and scope

Mindglass Procedure follows Miles Tegrof, who undergoes a fictional memory-erasure treatment after the drowning deaths of his wife and son, Noah. The film places him in a meticulously ordinary suburban environment populated by people who behave like neighbors while covertly testing his recollection. A photograph, a recurring phrase about water, and a child's mention of Noah destabilize the constructed reality; a laboratory recording then restores the context of Miles's loss. The revelation that he has undergone the treatment nine times turns the story into a cycle of attempted forgetting and renewed confrontation. This paper argues that the film's strongest idea is not simply that memories return, but that removing access to a painful memory does not itself settle the circumstances, guilt, or identity bound up with it. The analysis combines close reading of the film's reported scenes with research on memory modification, grief avoidance, autonomy, and visual storytelling. It treats the fictional procedure as a narrative device—not as a representation of an established clinical treatment—and distinguishes observable events from interpretation.

Method: The film is the primary text. IMDb and Vimeo are supporting public sources, while academic research supplies conceptual context. Film stills are drawn from the filmmakers’ supplied frames; the diagrams are original analytical illustrations.

1. The Film as a Primary Text

Mindglass Procedure is listed as a 2025 short of approximately five minutes, directed and written by Kaiya Crowley and Dominic Venticinque and made in association with Arbitrary Rhapsody. Its listed genres are drama, mystery, science fiction, and short film. The public listing describes Miles Tegrof waking in a strange but familiar neighborhood and rediscovering memories of his past. [1] A public Vimeo trailer also exists under the title Mindglass Procedure Trailer. [2] These materials establish the work's identity and the existence of public promotional media, but they do not replace the film itself as the primary source.

The paper's close reading follows the sequence described in the film: an abstract montage of water, an hourglass, family fragments, and a reaching hand; Miles waking and finding a photograph; strange encounters in an identical neighborhood; the conversation with Louis and Greta; Susie's mention of Noah; the laboratory and consent recording; and the final choice between remembering and forgetting. The film's own events are treated as evidence for interpretations, while external research is used only to clarify why those narrative choices may resonate with real-world debates.

This distinction matters. The fictional treatment is called neuromotive decoupling therapy within the story, but the existence of research into memory reconsolidation or memory modification does not mean that a real procedure can selectively erase a person's autobiographical history in the way depicted. The real-world connection is ethical and conceptual: how might changing a memory affect identity, agency, well-being, and relationships?

2. The Opening Montage: Fragmented Memory and Time

The film begins with a montage rather than a complete flashback. Rippling water, an hourglass, faint images of Miles's wife and son, and a reaching hand appear as disconnected fragments. The viewer is given signs of a family tragedy before receiving enough information to reconstruct it. The sequence therefore makes the audience experience a form of partial knowledge: the images are legible as emotionally connected, but their precise order and meaning remain uncertain.

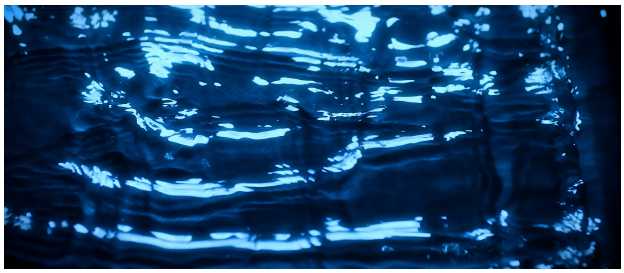

Figure 1. Water appears as an incomplete memory fragment.

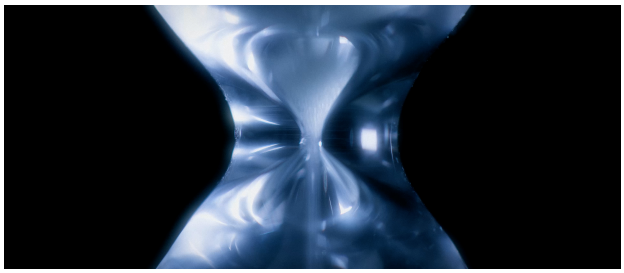

Figure 2. The hourglass visualizes passing time.

This is a narrative strategy as much as a visual one. The montage delays explanation and makes later scenes retroactively revise the opening. The phrase about the water, the torn photograph, and Noah's name all return to information that has already appeared in incomplete form. The audience does not merely receive new facts; it reinterprets earlier facts as the story supplies context. In a short film, this kind of visual economy is especially useful because a small number of recurring images can carry information across multiple scenes.

The reaching hand remains ambiguous. It may suggest attempted contact, a struggle, or an effort to reach another person, but the film's described events do not establish a single definitive meaning. Its strongest function is to embody a fragment whose emotional importance is apparent before its factual context is known. Keeping that ambiguity intact is more accurate than assigning the hand a precise action the film does not confirm.

The hourglass introduces the passage of time in a literal, visible form. Its contents move gradually through a narrow opening, suggesting both duration and limitation. Placed beside images of the family, it can be read as a reminder that time has passed without erasing the past. The later revelation of nine procedures also allows the hourglass to acquire a cyclical resonance: Miles repeatedly reaches the same decision rather than progressing toward a lasting resolution.

3. The Photograph: Evidence Outside Conscious Recall

The photograph falling from the kitchen cabinet is the first physical contradiction in Miles's apparently ordinary morning. It shows him with a woman and a child, but their faces have been torn out. The object is both evidence of a past relationship and an obstruction to recognizing it. The photograph preserves the family arrangement while withholding the most immediate identifying details.

Figure 3. The damaged family photograph preserves evidence of a relationship while obscuring identity.

Unlike the montage, the photograph is located in the present environment. It can be touched, examined, and kept even when Miles cannot explain it. This creates a distinction between the existence of evidence and the ability to interpret that evidence. The procedure may have changed Miles's conscious access to his history, but the photograph survives as a material trace of the life he is attempting to forget.

The torn faces invite a further interpretation: the image has been physically altered in a way that resembles the treatment's intended psychological effect. The faces are removed, but the rest of the photograph remains. That partial erasure mirrors the film's larger premise, in which the past is not eliminated from the world so much as made inaccessible to Miles. It is possible to infer that Miles himself tore the faces out before the procedure, but this remains an inference rather than an explicitly confirmed fact.

The photograph also foreshadows the procedure's limits. A controlled environment can be designed to feel ordinary, but it cannot guarantee that all traces of the former life have disappeared. The film uses a familiar domestic object—not a futuristic device—to introduce the first crack in the artificial reality. This makes the speculative premise legible through a small, concrete detail.

4. The Neighborhood: Artificial Normality and Surveillance

The neighborhood is constructed from recognizable suburban elements: houses, lawns, a jogger, neighbors, and children playing outside. Its unease comes not from an obviously fantastic appearance but from its excessive sameness and the residents' oddly timed behavior. When the children shout, "He's awake!", the line suggests that Miles's waking is an anticipated event rather than a private, ordinary moment.

Figure 4. Repeated suburban architecture makes the apparently ordinary environment feel staged.

The woman jogging asks whether Miles is feeling better, then leaves before he can answer. Another neighbor describes a dream in which his family was gone and asks Miles whether he has had strange dreams. Each encounter seems plausible in isolation, but together they create a pattern: the residents ask questions that appear to probe Miles's emotional state and memory, then withdraw before a normal conversation can develop.

THE NEIGHBORHOOD	THE LABORATORY
Ordinary houses and lawns	Medical setting becomes visible
Neighbors act as familiar people	Consent recording restores context
Memory tested through conversation	Procedure and repetition revealed

Figure 5. Original analytical diagram contrasting the two primary environments and their narrative functions.

Once the laboratory scene reveals the procedure's structure, the neighborhood can be understood as an environment of covert observation. The residents are actors, and their social interactions double as tests. The film's suspense therefore arises from a mismatch in knowledge. Miles believes he is moving through an ordinary community; the audience gradually suspects that the community is organized around a hidden purpose.

This can be read as a form of soft surveillance. Rather than using visible cameras or overt interrogation, the environment gathers information through apparently casual social contact. The technique is dramatically effective because the people do not need to threaten Miles to unsettle him. Their familiarity, evasiveness, and repeated questions are enough to make the ordinary setting feel staged.

5. Louis, Greta, and the Performance of Care

Louis and Greta provide the longest social interaction in the neighborhood. They invite Miles to sit with them, and the three children are nearby, creating the appearance of a relaxed gathering. Their manner is familiar, but their questions leave Miles increasingly unsure of his place in the community. The scene combines hospitality with assessment: Miles is welcomed into a conversation that also tests what he remembers.

Figure 6. Louis and Greta’s neighborly interaction doubles as an assessment of Miles’s memory.

Greta's line, "It's alright to forget the little things," initially sounds reassuring. In the context of the procedure, however, it acquires a second meaning. The line makes forgetting sound casual and manageable, even as the story concerns the removal of memories tied to a major personal loss. The contrast between the calm delivery and the stakes of the situation contributes to the scene's unease.

Louis's remark, "the water's great," works as a callback to Miles's earlier encouragement for his wife and son to enter the water. The words appear harmless within the neighborhood, but the opening montage gives them an association the audience can recognize. This is a compact example of how a repeated line can carry information without a character explaining it. The line connects the artificial present to the buried memory and lets the viewer register a connection before Miles does.

The scene also shows how the constructed reality depends on performance. Louis and Greta must behave like ordinary neighbors while trying to determine whether the procedure has worked. Their apparent concern is therefore complicated by their concealed purpose. The film does not require the audience to conclude that every gesture is insincere; rather, it presents a situation in which care and control are difficult to separate because Miles does not know what the interaction is for.

6. Noah's Name and the Return of Context

Susie's question, "Like Noah?", breaks the conversation's careful rhythm. Until this moment, Miles has encountered clues without a stable explanation. The name supplies a specific point of recognition and begins to reconnect him with the family whose faces were removed from the photograph.

Figure 7. Noah’s name reconnects Miles with information the procedure has obscured.

Greta's immediate distress and decision to send the children away confirm that the name has crossed a boundary. The adults may be able to guide the conversation, but they cannot undo the information that has already reached Miles. The child's unscripted-seeming remark exposes the fragility of the controlled environment: one unexpected word can undo the performance on which the procedure depends.

The film's trigger is not a deliberate search for the past. Miles does not sit down to reconstruct his memories; another person names someone important to him. This gives the scene a different dramatic shape from a conventional detective revelation. The information arrives through an ordinary conversation and changes the meaning of everything around it.

The moment should not be treated as a scientific demonstration that autobiographical memory necessarily returns through a single name or cue. The procedure is fictional and the scene is written for dramatic clarity. As storytelling, however, it presents memory as connected to people, language, objects, and context—not merely as a file that can be permanently deleted.

7. Water, the Hourglass, and Recurring Visual Motifs

Water links the film's opening, its central conversation, and its final explanation of the family's deaths. At first, it appears as a visual fragment. Later, the phrase "the water's great" recalls the opening. Finally, the consent recording establishes the drowning as the event Miles associates with his guilt. The motif gains meaning through repetition, not through a single explanatory speech.

The water image carries a double association. It belongs to the ordinary physical world, but in Miles's history it is connected to irreversible loss. When Louis repeats the phrase, the neighborhood's casual tone collides

with the memory's emotional context. The same words can sound neutral or painful depending on what the listener knows.

The hourglass and the water also form a useful visual pair. Both are fluid or moving substances contained by a frame: water is shaped by its surroundings, while sand passes through a narrow opening. As interpretive motifs, they suggest the tension between what is contained, what escapes, and what continues moving despite attempts to control it. The film does not explicitly state this symbolism, so it should be understood as a reading of the images rather than an established production explanation.

The recurring reaching hand remains less determinate. It can be associated with contact or rescue, but the story does not provide enough detail to identify exactly whose hand it is or what action it represents. Its ambiguity is consistent with the montage's larger function: the audience sees a meaningful fragment before it can assign the fragment a fixed place in the event.

8. The Laboratory, the Recording, and Informed Consent

After Miles remembers Noah, Louis and Greta restrain him, and he wakes in a dark laboratory. The change of setting makes visible what the neighborhood concealed. The houses and lawns are replaced by a medical environment, and the interactions that seemed like awkward social encounters become understandable as part of a procedure.

Figure 8. The laboratory makes the medical context visible.

Figure 9. The recording preserves Miles’s prior account and consent.

The projector plays Miles's earlier consent recording. This is a particularly effective narrative device because the explanation comes from Miles himself. The recorded version of Miles describes the drowning and his sense of responsibility, while the present Miles must confront a history he had chosen to remove from his awareness. The

recording places two versions of the same person in direct relation: one who knew the past and one who has temporarily lost access to it.

The scene raises a question about consent over time. A prior decision may have been made voluntarily, but does that decision settle every later question if the treatment changes the person's ability to remember why they consented? The film does not provide a legal or clinical answer. It dramatizes the ethical problem by showing that the recording can document a past decision but cannot make the current decision for Miles.

The distinction is central to real-world debates about memory-modifying technologies. Yang's 2024 review argues that autonomy discussions can become too abstract unless they pay close attention to informed consent and the practical circumstances in which decisions are made. [4] In the film, the issue is especially

sharp because Miles's current understanding of the treatment is deliberately restricted by the artificial environment.

The laboratory reveal also retroactively changes the status of Louis and Greta. They are not simply strange neighbors; they are personnel involved in the procedure. The film thus shifts from uncertainty about the setting to uncertainty about Miles's future decision. The first mystery is solved, but the ethical conflict becomes more explicit.

9. Grief Avoidance and Real-World Psychological Research

The film's most direct real-world connection is not literal memory erasure but experiential avoidance: efforts to avoid thoughts, feelings, reminders, or situations associated with distress. Miles's motive is tied to a bereavement and to his belief that he bears responsibility for the deaths. The procedure dramatizes an extreme version of avoiding the memories through which that loss is experienced.

Research does not support the simple claim that all avoidance is harmful. Katherine Shear's discussion of experiential avoidance in bereavement distinguishes between avoidance that can help a person manage the acute intensity of grief and persistent avoidance that may hinder adjustment. [7] This nuance matters: people often need temporary breaks from painful reminders, and grieving does not follow a single prescribed schedule.

A systematic review by Eisma and colleagues examined 64 studies involving 7,715 bereaved people. It found strong evidence that experiential avoidance and rumination can play a role in the persistence of complicated grief, while also noting that laboratory findings were mixed. [6] The findings are relevant as context, not as a diagnosis of Miles. The film depicts a fictional intervention and a fictional pattern of memory recovery; it cannot establish what would happen to a real person in comparable circumstances.

The nine-procedure reveal gives the avoidance theme its clearest form. Miles has repeatedly chosen to remove his memories, yet the film returns him to the same decision. The cycle suggests that suppressing access to a painful event has not settled the feelings or questions attached to it. This is a narrative analogy to avoidance, not evidence that every attempt to avoid grief necessarily creates a loop.

The film is also careful, at least in its ending, not to show what healthy grieving would look like for Miles. It does not depict therapy, social support, acceptance, or a long process of adaptation. The story stops at the choice. Its claim is therefore strongest when phrased narrowly: Miles's repeated erasure has not produced a lasting resolution within the events the film reveals.

10. Memory Modification, Identity, and Autonomy

Current research into memory modification includes interventions that may alter how memories are stored, retrieved, or emotionally experienced. These methods are not equivalent to the complete, selective autobiographical erasure depicted in Mindglass Procedure. Phelps and Hofmann's review describes research into memory editing and reconsolidation while emphasizing that translation from experimental findings to clinical practice has been challenging and that benefits have been inconsistent. [3]

A scoping review by Yang identifies six recurring ethical themes in memory-modification research: selfhood and identity, autonomy and informed consent, welfare, safety, responsibility, and social and legal justice. [5] These themes map onto the film's plot without making the fictional treatment medically realistic. Miles's memories shape his understanding of who he is, his consent recording preserves a past decision, and the procedure affects his ability to understand his social relationships.

The film also raises a relational question. The treatment is not only about Miles's internal state; it alters his relationship to the people he has lost and to the people who are now interacting with him. His neighbors seem to know him, but their knowledge is not shared equally. The resulting environment limits his ability to make sense of others' intentions, making memory a social resource as well as a personal one.

Zawadzki's work on memory modification and narrative identity argues that changes to self-defining memories may affect how a person understands themselves and relates to others, while also acknowledging that memory modification may have potential benefits in some circumstances. [8] This balanced view is useful for reading the film. It avoids assuming that preserving every painful memory is always desirable, while still recognizing that altering memory can have consequences beyond immediate emotional relief.

The ethical question is therefore not simply whether a person should be allowed to forget. It is whether the person can make an informed decision about what forgetting means for their identity, relationships, and future choices. Miles's final dilemma remains unresolved because the film does not tell us whether he will accept the burden of remembering or choose the temporary relief of erasure again.

11. The Nine-Procedure Loop and the Unresolved Ending

The revelation that Miles has undergone the procedure nine times reframes the story from a one-time failure into a repeating pattern. The neighborhood is no longer simply a strange setting; it becomes one stage in a cycle that has already occurred repeatedly. The exact details of the previous treatments are not shown, so the film establishes repetition without supplying a full chronology.

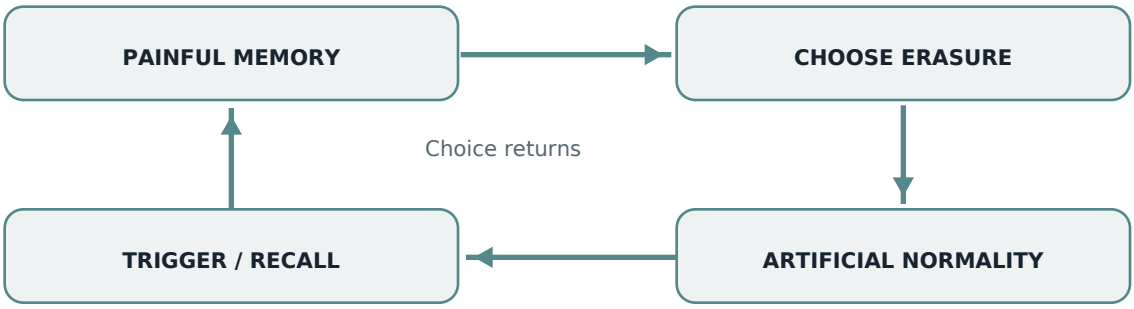

Figure 10. Interpretive model of the cycle implied by the ending; this is not a literal diagram shown in the film.

The repetition is both plot information and thematic structure. Miles attempts to escape his memories, but the story brings him back to the moment when he must choose whether to remember. The audience experiences a similar re-evaluation: the earlier scenes are not discarded, but reinterpreted as part of a

repeated process.

Figure 11. The final question withholds Miles’s decision and refuses easy closure.

The ending withholds Miles's decision. If he chooses to forget, the cycle may continue; if he chooses to remember, he may begin a different relationship with his past. Neither outcome is shown, and the film does not guarantee that remembering would automatically resolve his grief. This restraint prevents the ending from becoming a simple lesson in which one option is explicitly rewarded.

The final question—"Remember or forget"—is powerful because Miles has recovered the information but not yet decided what to do with it. Knowledge and action are separated. The film ends at the point where the central conflict becomes a conscious choice, leaving the audience to consider whether the desire to avoid pain can itself become a source of repetition.

12. Cinematography, Editing, Production Design, and Sound

The film's visual approach is described as being influenced by Minority Report (2002), photographed by Janusz Kamiński. Accounts of that film's look describe a deliberately desaturated, high-contrast image, with bleach-bypass processing, increased grain, strong highlights, and deep shadows contributing to an unsettling near-future atmosphere. [9] The useful comparison is not that the two films are identical, but that visual design can make a speculative environment feel at once recognizable and estranged.

Figure 12. Familiar space is rendered unsettling through repetition.

Figure 13. The contrasting laboratory image reframes earlier scenes.

In Mindglass Procedure, the neighborhood's apparent normality is part of the story's deception. Identical homes, maintained lawns, and ordinary domestic activities initially suggest stability. The repeated patterns and strange interactions gradually make the same environment feel artificial. Production design therefore carries narrative information: the setting appears to be a community, but it behaves like a controlled system.

The shift to the dark laboratory provides a visual contrast that supports the reveal. Where the neighborhood conceals the procedure behind a familiar social surface, the laboratory makes the medical context visible. The contrast can be understood as a shift from performance to explanation. The change in space helps the viewer reclassify the earlier scenes without requiring a lengthy verbal explanation.

The opening montage relies on editing to withhold context. Short fragments appear before the viewer can assemble them into a stable account. The later water callback uses a different form of repetition: rather than repeating an image, the film repeats a phrase, allowing dialogue to trigger recognition. Both techniques invite the audience to participate in the reconstruction of the story.

The photograph and consent recording serve as contrasting props. The photograph is incomplete and silent; it offers visual evidence but no explanation. The recording is verbal and explicit; it supplies Miles's own account of the past.

Together, the objects show two different ways information can survive the procedure: one through a material trace and one through a preserved record of the person who made the original decision.

Sound and dialogue are especially important because several of the film's clues arrive as spoken lines. "He's awake!" makes Miles's waking sound like an event being monitored. The water remark links the present to the opening montage. Susie's mention of Noah breaks the adults' controlled conversation. Each line changes the audience's understanding of the environment, so dialogue functions as a mechanism of revelation rather than merely as exposition.

A limitation of this section is that the available research material did not include production notes, a shot list, camera settings, lighting diagrams, or an interview with the filmmakers explaining specific technical choices. Accordingly, the analysis describes how the techniques function in the story as presented, rather than claiming to know the precise equipment or intention behind every shot.

13. The Title and Surname as Compact Thematic Devices

The title Mindglass Procedure places the mind beside an object associated with transparency, reflection, and separation. This is an interpretive reading rather than a confirmed statement of the filmmakers' intent. Glass can allow something to be seen while still separating the observer from it; that association resembles Miles's experience of encountering traces of his past without initially understanding them.

The word "procedure" emphasizes that the alteration is organized and deliberate. Miles's memory loss is not simply an unexplained accident; it is connected to a treatment that involves consent, medical personnel, and a designed environment. The title therefore joins a psychological subject to an institutional process.

Miles's surname, Tegrof, spells "Forget" backward. The reversal creates a concise linguistic connection to the film's central action. It is not necessary to treat the name as a complete explanation of the character; it

works as an additional thematic clue that becomes especially relevant after the final choice is stated.

Both devices—the title and surname—are economical. They add another layer of meaning without changing the literal sequence of events. Like the photograph and water callback, they reward attention to details that acquire significance through their relation to the larger story.

14. Limitations and Alternative Readings

A responsible analysis should separate confirmed events from interpretation. The film establishes that Miles's family drowned, that he blames himself, that he undergoes a fictional memory-erasure treatment, that Louis and Greta are involved in the procedure, and that he has undergone it nine times before. It does not fully establish who tore the faces from the photograph, exactly what the reaching hand represents, or what Miles chooses at the end.

The artificial neighborhood can be read as a metaphor for surveillance, a controlled clinical environment, or a staged reconstruction of normal life. These readings are compatible, but they are not identical. The strongest common ground is the mismatch between the neighborhood's ordinary appearance and its concealed function.

Likewise, the film can be read as a criticism of avoidance without concluding that every effort to reduce painful memories is unethical. Research on memory modification includes both potential therapeutic benefits and concerns about identity, autonomy, and unintended consequences. [3–5, 8] The film's clearest criticism is directed at the repeated cycle and its failure to resolve Miles's underlying conflict, not at every conceivable intervention that might alter memory.

Finally, the film's short runtime means that some details remain intentionally compressed. The audience does not receive a full account of the previous nine procedures or a complete explanation of the treatment's operation. Rather than treating every unanswered question as a flaw, the analysis can recognize that the ending's uncertainty is part of its design while still noting the limits of what can be concluded.

Conclusion

Mindglass Procedure uses a fictional memory-erasure treatment to examine the difference between escaping a painful memory and resolving the experience attached to it. The opening montage gives the audience fragments before their meaning is clear; the photograph preserves evidence of a family Miles cannot recognize; the neighborhood turns ordinary social interaction into covert testing; and the water callback connects casual dialogue to the circumstances of the family's deaths.

The laboratory scene supplies the context that the neighborhood withheld. Miles learns what happened to his family and discovers that the treatment has been repeated nine times. This revelation changes the film's structure: the story is no longer only about recovering a lost memory, but about returning to the same choice again and again.

Research on grief avoidance and memory modification helps clarify the real-world questions raised by the premise. Avoidance can sometimes provide temporary relief, while persistent avoidance may be associated

with difficulties in grief adjustment. Memory modification also raises questions about identity, autonomy, informed consent, and social relationships. These connections should remain contextual rather than literal: the film's procedure is fictional and should not be confused with established clinical practice.

The ending's refusal to show Miles's decision is consistent with the film's central concern. Remembering does not automatically solve his grief, and forgetting has not produced a lasting resolution within the cycle the film reveals. Miles must decide what to do with the knowledge he has recovered, and the audience is left without confirmation of his choice.

The film's most defensible central claim is that, in Miles's case, repeatedly removing access to painful memories has not brought the conflict to a lasting resolution. Its final question remains open, but the preceding nine procedures give that question weight: the same decision has returned before, and the film ends at the point where Miles must decide whether to repeat it.

15. Production Context and Recognition

Mindglass Procedure was created for the 2025 SkillsUSA National Leadership & Skills Conference (NLSC) Digital Cinema competition. The film placed second nationally; SkillsUSA maintains an official medalist lookup for its National Leadership & Skills Conference, linked in the references. Dominic Venticinque and Kaiya Crowley co-directed, co-wrote, co-photographed, and co-edited the project, which was made in association with Arbitrary Rhapsody. The competition setting helps explain the concentrated storytelling: within a runtime of approximately five minutes, the short must establish a character, construct an unstable world, reverse the viewer’s understanding, and leave its central ethical question unresolved.

The film also received festival and student-production recognition. The filmmakers report an Emerging finalist placement and Best Acting at Bucks County FilmFest in 2025; the festival’s public awards archive confirms an Emerging finalist listing, while the precise Best Acting wording is not independently established by that archive. The film also received the “Visual Treat” award at the Greenfield Youth Film Festival (2026), with the festival archive linked below. Other distinctions reported by the filmmakers include first place in Narrative at Behind the Lens Film Festival (2026) and Best Sound Design at Behind the Lens Film Festival (2025). The official NATAS Mid-Atlantic Chapter nominee listing confirms a 2026 High School Student Production Awards nomination in HS04 — Short Form, credited to MBIT.

These distinctions supply production context rather than proof of any particular interpretation. The film’s critical interest still rests on the evidence within the work: the controlled neighborhood, the recurring imagery, the recorded consent statement, and the unresolved repetition of the procedure.

References and Further Viewing

The film remains the primary text. External works provide contextual research, production information, and related viewing. Source numbers correspond to the references used in the original analytical text.

[1] Crowley, Kaiya, and Dominic Venticinque, directors. Mindglass Procedure. Made in association with Arbitrary Rhapsody, 2025. Short film, approximately five minutes. IMDb title listing. https://www.imdb.com/title/tt38733948/

[2] Mindglass Procedure Trailer. Vimeo. https://vimeo.com/1096322249

[3] Phelps, Elizabeth A., and Stefan G. Hofmann. “Memory Editing from Science Fiction to Clinical Practice.” Nature, vol. 572, 2019, pp. 43–50. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-019-1433-7

[4] Yang, Junjie. “Personal Autonomy in Memory Modification Technology: A Critical Assessment.” Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, vol. 11, 2024, article 1225. https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-03736-5

[5] Yang, Junjie. “Ethical Issues in Memory Modification Technology: A Scoping Review.” Journal of Bioethical Inquiry, vol. 22, no. 2, 2025, pp. 359–380. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11673-024-10371-x

[6] Eisma, Maarten C., and M. S. Harrold. “Emotion Regulatory Strategies in Complicated Grief: A Systematic Review.” Behavior Therapy, vol. 52, no. 1, 2021, pp. 234–249. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beth.2020.04.004

[7] Shear, M. Katherine. “Exploring the Role of Experiential Avoidance from the Perspective of Attachment Theory and the Dual Process Model.” OMEGA—Journal of Death and Dying, vol. 61, no. 4, 2010, pp. 357–369. https://doi.org/10.2190/OM.61.4.f

[8] Zawadzki, Przemysław. “The Ethics of Memory Modification: Personal Narratives, Relational Selves and Autonomy.” Neuroethics, vol. 16, 2023, article 6. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12152-022-09512-z

[9] Arnold, Jeremy. “Minority Report.” Turner Classic Movies. https://www.tcm.com/articles/648300/minority-report

[10] SkillsUSA. “National Leadership & Skills Conference.” https://www.skillsusa.org/events/national-leadership-skills-conference/

[11] Bucks County FilmFest. “Awards.” https://buckscountyfilmfest.com/awards/

[12] NATAS Mid-Atlantic Chapter. “2026 High School Student Nominees,” HS04 — Short Form. https://natasmid-atlantic.org/students/high-school/2026-high-school-student-nominees/

[13] SkillsUSA. “Competition Medalists / Winners.” Official medalist lookup for NLSC events, including 2025. https://www.skillsusa-register.org/rpts/EventMedalists.aspx

[14] SkillsUSA. “Scores and Medalist Photos.” Explanation of national results and historical medalist records. https://www.skillsusa.org/competitions/skillsusa-championships/scores-and-medalist-photos/

[15] Greenfield Youth Film Festival. “Festival Archive.” http://www.greenfieldfilmfestival.org/festival-archive/

[16] Arbitrary Rhapsody. Official website and film portfolio. https://www.arbitraryrhapsody.com/

Source notes

• The fictional neuromotive decoupling therapy is not presented as an established clinical intervention. Research on grief and memory modification provides conceptual context rather than a diagnosis of Miles.

• The paper distinguishes confirmed narrative events from plausible interpretations, including uncertainty about the damaged photograph, the reaching hand, and Miles’s final decision.

• All photographic figures are authentic stills from the filmmakers’ supplied frame archive. The environment comparison and procedure-loop figures are original analytical diagrams.

• Award statements not independently established by a cited public source are identified as filmmaker-reported.